

LGs Panther

LG has unveiled their first WM7 phone. They're calling it panther

Native Opera Mini for WM

A native version of Opera Mini for WM has been released, removing the need for Java dependency

Q What is the difference between AMD & Intel processors? Which processor is best for gaming? What is the PC configuration for gaming that should not exceed Rs 50,000

B Venkatesh

A Both a different brands, with different design ethos making products for the same x86-computing platform. So while their products are different in terms of design, they are designed around certain parameters that are not so different. For gaming I would recommend going with a Core i7 system. Suggested system configuration is:

Phenom X4 945	8100
ASUS M4A78-PRO	5850
2 x 2GB DDR2 800 MHz (Corsair)	4000
Sapphire Radeon HD 4850	6900
Seagate 1 TB 7200.12	3600
BenQ G2220HD	9200
CoolerMaster 690	4400
Corsair VX 450	3800
Altec Lansing VS2421	2200
Logitech Multimedia	500
Logitech MX518	1300
Total	49850

Q Which brand would you suggest me to go for Dell or Lenovo? The 2958G6Q from Lenovo looks good to me with the required configuration. The same configuration in Dell is expensive. But my friends suggest me to go for Dell as they say that Lenovo parts are not reliable. I would like to know your opinion.

Mann NS

A Both a large brands with a pretty good service network and spread across the country. Reliability is not an easy factor to comment on. I would go with the cheaper of the two alternatives, other things remaining the same. Check for warranty periods – Dell does have extended warranty options, check and see if Lenovo can swing you a similar deal, their warranties are typically one or two years – Dells are three and five years.

Q I am planning to buy a laptop for 60k. I am mainly going to use it for surfing, gaming and for multimedia (watch and edit movies, live streaming,

listening to music). What is the better one? Sony VAIO CW Series or Lenovo Ideapad Y730 or Dell Studio 15. Please help me to choose one. Also recommend me another models within this price range (with only Intel processors.)

Selvakumar

A The notebooks you have mentioned are all pretty different, albeit with somewhat similar configs. The Lenovo is a 17-inch solution aimed at gamers, the Studio 15 is aimed at users wanting a powerful configuration not for gaming while the Vaio CW is a series with 14-inch screens and a little more focus on styling. If you are moving around and plan to cart your notebook around, I recommend the Vaio CW. If this is a desktop replacement, get the Lenovo Y730. Whichever configuration you choose, for gaming, make sure you have a good graphics solution and 3 or 4 GB of memory.

Q I'm looking for a music phone, my budget is upto 8000. I would ideally like a Nokia phone.

Bharat Razdan

A I would recommend either Nokia's 5230 or their X3. The latter is a music phone, and has a neat slider form factor. The latter is derived from the 5800 XpressMusic – a decent phone. It has a larger screen that is touch-based. Totally depends on which you prefer. Both will be within your budget.

Q I am planning to buy a wireless router and my budget is Rs. 3,000 to 4,000. The router should have good range and should be fast. I have 512 kbps Internet connection.

Farooq Ahmed Khan

A Firstly, even if you had a 20 mbps Internet connection, a router would easily handle that transfer rate. The concept of a router slowing down your Internet connection due to its internal bandwidth is totally wrong – unless it is horribly placed or you have a really sprawling palatial house. I would recommend Linksys' WRT120N priced at Rs. 2,550 – this will more than suffice.

Q I have an Intel DG33 motherboard, but the on-board graphics cannot play many games like Turok, Fallout-3, Crysis etc. So, I am going to buy a graphics card within a budget of Rs. 5000.

Also the card should run in my humble 450 Watt Frontech SMPS. I am confused about the following points.

Although this card is said as the newer 9th generation card, the price of an older 8800 is higher than the 9400 or 9600 ones. Also there is the GS, GTS and GTX tags which adds to my confusion.

2. Games like 'Crysis' requires 6800GT equivalent card. How do I compare this equivalence in the 9000 series cards?

3. Compared to the 9400GT, the price of 9600GT is very high, almost twice. Is there any substantial advantage of a 9600GT over the 9400 ones?

Kindly suggest a good selection, or should I go for the latest 200 series cards, increasing the budget? I am not an avid gamer, the card should just be able to run most of the games in playable condition – that is my only requirement.

Anupom Bora, Assam.

A The G33 is not even enough to play very basic 3D games. For Rs. 5,000 you can easily pick up a GeForce 9600 GT. Look for brands like ZOTAC or Palit, I suggest ZOTAC for they are very reliable. If you increase your budget to say Rs. 6,500 you could also pick up a Sapphire Radeon HD 4850 – an older card, but a pretty powerful one. In response to your queries:

The prices of 8 series cards are higher, because they were costlier to manufacture, their GPUs being made on an older, bigger fabrication process. They are also EOL (End Of Life), which means vendors can price them at whatever they wish.

2). The 9xxx series is much more powerful, not really a fair comparison i.e. products being three generations apart.

3). I surprised that the 9400GT was priced as high as 5K in Assam. It's available for as little as Rs. 3,000 here. The 9600GT is a much better part, that will give you at least 2x the performance. Go for 512 MB DDR3 memory, a 1 GB part is of little use on such low-to-mid-range GPUs. 